



crossed six metres in a single competition. But while Sam Kendricks and Emmanouil Karalis have done all they could, Duplantis is just getting started. From here on, his competition is with himself. Almost casually, Duplantis set the bar up at 6.26 metres — 1 centimetre higher than the world record he himself had set less than a month before at the Paris Olympics.

At the Stade de Paris, amidst the ecstatic cheers of 40,000 spectators and the applause of his competitors, Duplantis had cleared the height. After landing on the mat, he sprinted off to celebrate with family and friends. Earlier, he had marked his Olympic Record achievement with a finger-pistol salute for the cameras, inspired by Turkish shooter and Paris Olympics silver medallist Yusuf Dikec.

In Silesia, Duplantis follows a nearly identical routine. He charges down the runway with incredible speed, holding his pole high above his head to maximize the energy needed to bend the fibreglass instrument. His plant is near perfect, transferring the energy efficiently into his swing. Without hesitation, he inverts himself completely until he is almost vertical above the ground. Each step gains him crucial inches, and as he turns his body at the peak of the movement, he ensures he retains every bit of height.

When he lands on the mat, it seems Duplantis doesn't really know how to celebrate the new world record. He high-fives the mascot, then runs past a gaggle of photographers before lying down on the track.

Peerless: When Armand Duplantis enters an event now, his only real competition is with himself. What else can you expect from the man who has broken the world record 10 times over the last four years. REUTERS

When you are Duplantis, though, this makes sense. Just how many different celebrations can you come up with, even if for a new world record?

Duplantis should probably practise a few options for the future. When he enters an event now, his only real competition is with himself. What else can you expect from the man who has broken the world record 10 times over the last four years.

In fact, Duplantis is so good at his